

Compile, Do Not Theme

The white belt gathers raw customer feedback into one tidy place; finding patterns comes much later.

The Line

The most important thing in this section is one line. You compile. You do not theme. Compiling means gathering all the raw feedback into one organized place, by source, with the customers' own words preserved. Theming means finding patterns and deciding which complaints are most common, and that is analysis.

Whose Job

Theming and analysis are yellow-belt work and above. They happen later, in the Analyze phase, with care and with data. Compiling is the white-belt job, and it is genuinely valuable, because the team cannot analyze anything until someone has pulled it all together.

Why It Matters

A team that mixes compiling and analyzing too early locks in an early interpretation, which can blind them to better ones later. Keeping the raw voice of the customer tidy and unanalyzed gives the team room to discover the right themes when the time comes. Your discipline protects the quality of the whole project.

Remember this

Staying on the compile side of the line is not a limitation; it protects the project.